



Week 3 Lab – Sprint Backlogs in Jira

In this lab, we will explore how to add **story point estimates** to your product backlog, how to set up a **sprint backlog** using Jira, and how to activate **burndown chart** reports.

Story Point Estimates

Adding story point estimates to product backlog items (i.e. “work items”) in Jira is quite straightforward. (The harder part is coming up with the estimates themselves. 😊)

1. Log in to Jira. Open the test space you created in Week 2, then select the “Backlog” link from the horizontal menu at the top of the page.
2. Click on one of the backlog items you created in Week 2, e.g. “Accept Credit Card Payments”.
3. Look for the “Details” box on the right-hand side, then scroll down to the “Story point estimate” field:

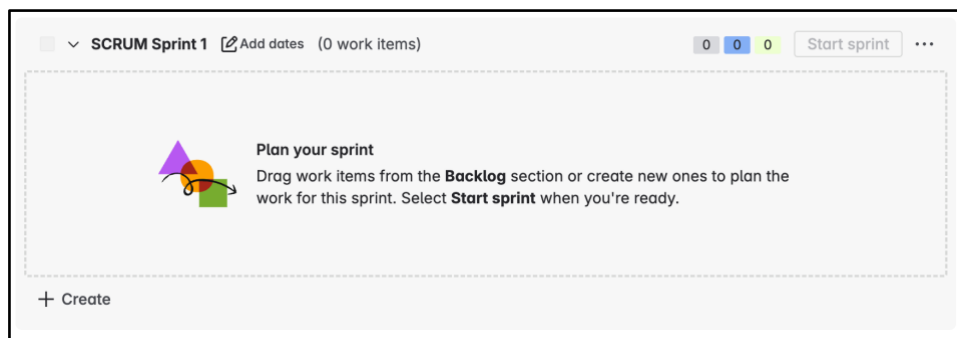
4. Click on “None” and enter a numeric point value from the modified Fibonacci sequence (e.g. “8”) and click the tick.
5. Add some story point values to any other items in your backlog (don’t worry about the accuracy of your estimates – this is just to learn Jira). You can also directly add story points from the product backlog list by clicking the “-”:

Item	Story Point Estimate
SCRUM-6 Accept Credit Card Payments	8
SCRUM-7 Accept PayNow Payments	-
SCRUM-8 Accept Instalment-Based Payments	8
SCRUM-9 Reset Forgotten Password	5

Planning a Sprint

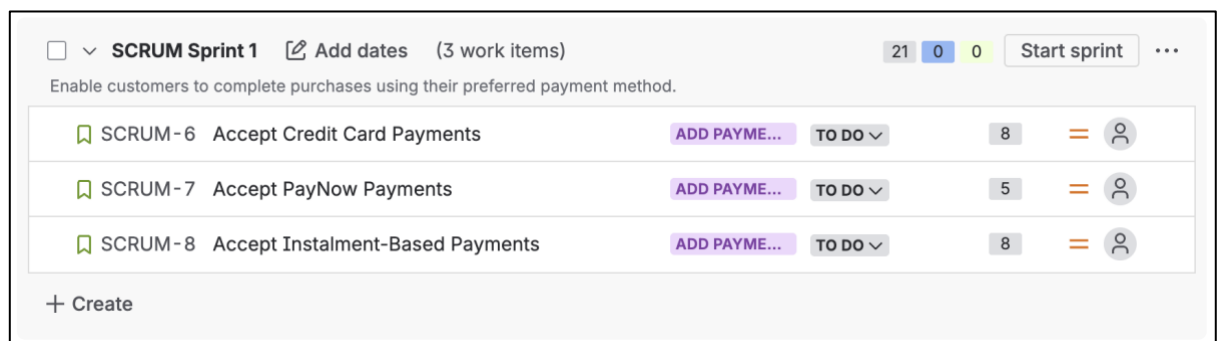
This section of the lab will get you familiar with the essentials of creating a sprint backlog and configuring a sprint.

1. On the “Backlog” page of your Jira space, click on “Create sprint”.
2. At the top of the page, you should now see an empty sprint backlog:



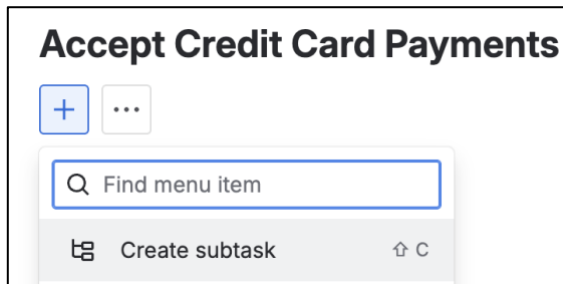
3. Click the “Add dates” link to the right of “SCRUM Sprint 1”. Choose a duration (e.g. “2 weeks”) and leave the start/end dates blank. Enter a sprint goal, e.g. *“Enable customers to complete purchases using their preferred payment method.”* Click “Update”.
4. Drag and drop all the user stories you would like to include in this sprint. For example, you can filter by the epic you created last week (“Add Payment Methods”) and drag over all user stories related to payment options.

After dragging them into the SCRUM Sprint 1 box, you should see something like this:

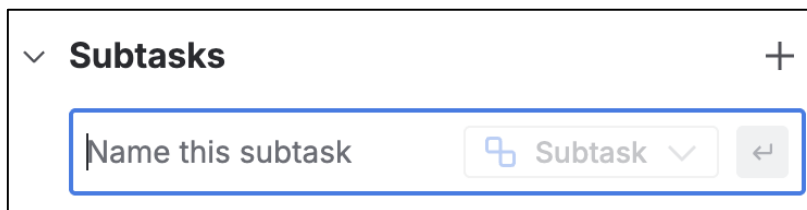


5. Before starting the sprint, let’s create a few “Tasks” for one of the stories in the sprint backlog. Click on “Accept Credit Card Payments”.

6. The story should appear on the right-hand side. Click the “+” underneath the user story title then “Create subtask”:



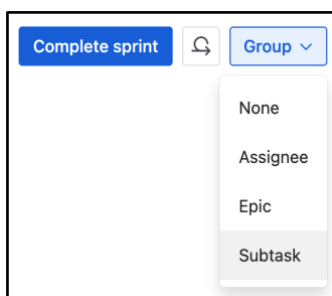
7. You can directly create several tasks (“Subtasks” in Jira terminology) for this user story:



For example, you could create the following tasks:

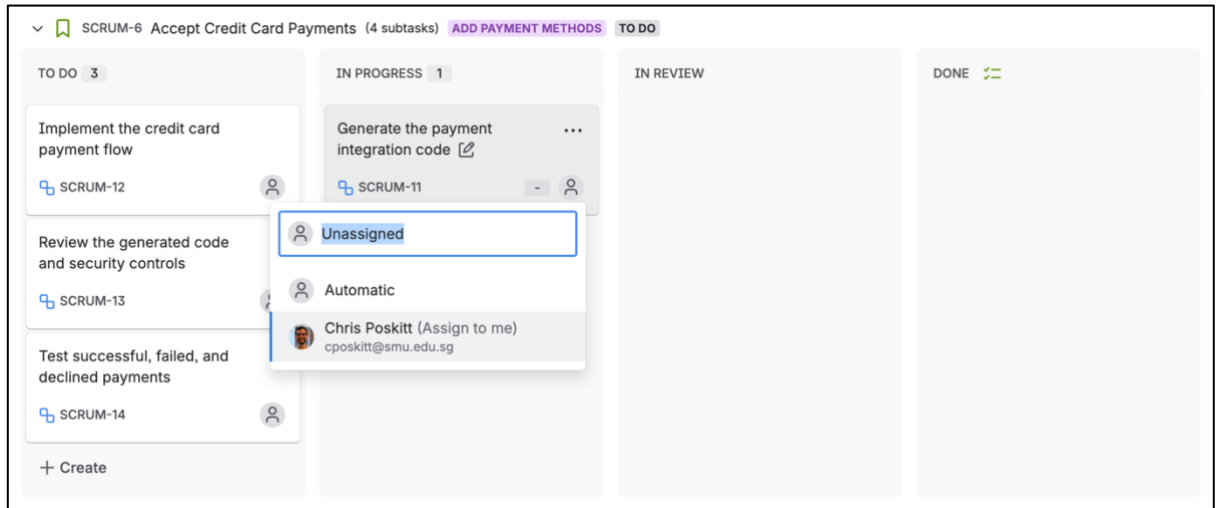
- “Generate the payment integration code”
- “Implement the credit card payment flow”
- “Review the generated code and security controls”
- “Test successful, failed, and declined payments”

8. You can create similar tasks for the other user stories on your sprint backlog too.
9. Return to the “Backlog” page in Jira and click “Start Sprint” → “Start”.
10. Now that the sprint has started, let’s take a look at your sprint taskboard! Click on the “Board” link, and the taskboard for your active sprint should be visible.
11. Currently, it will only be showing you the user stories (and not the subtasks you created). To address this, locate the following menu:



...and select “Subtask”.

12. You can start dragging and dropping tasks into the “In Progress” column and then assign them to team members. For example:

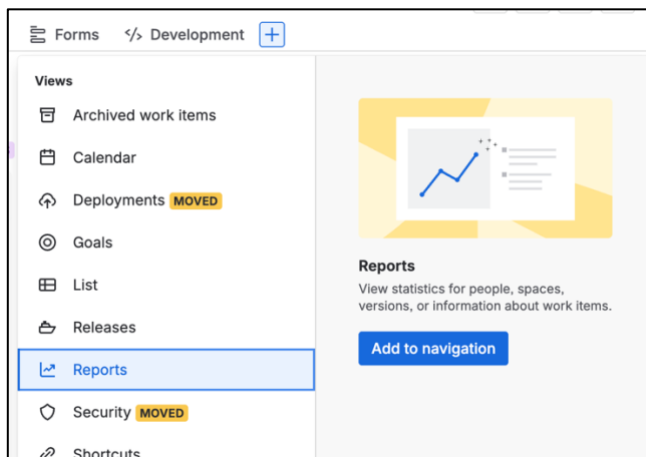


We leave you to experiment with the rest of Jira’s features in this mock sprint. 😊

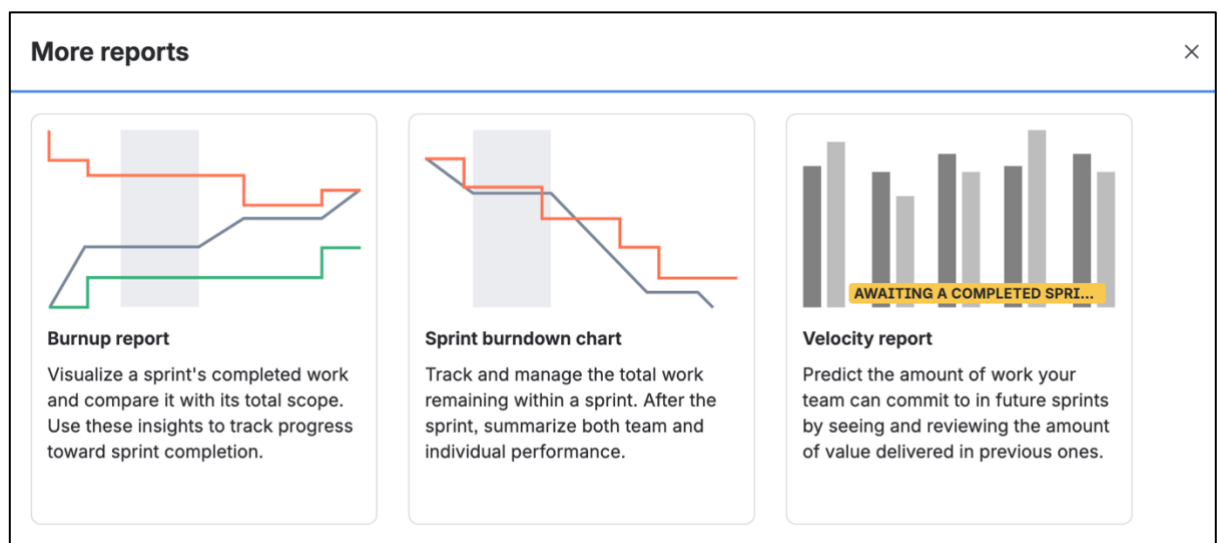
Enabling Burndown Charts

This final section of the lab will show you how to activate burndown chart reports in Jira.

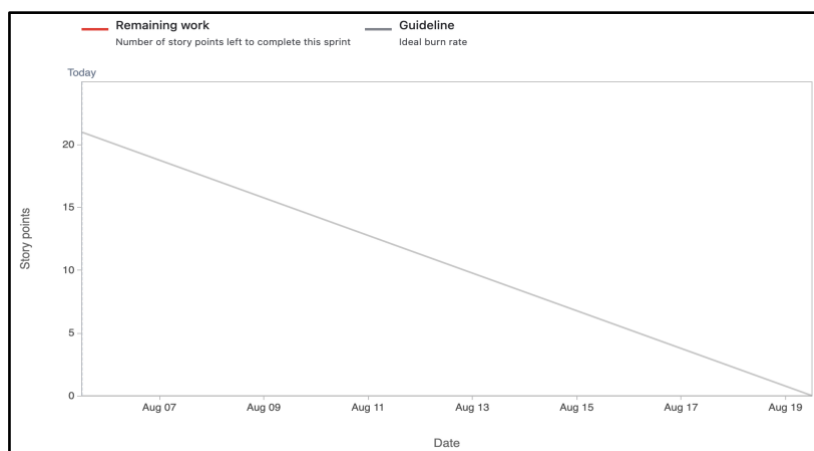
1. Burndown charts are not available by default. To enable them, open your Jira space, select the “+” button at the end of the horizontal menu bar, then click on “Reports”, then “Add to navigation”:



2. You'll see a dashboard of helpful metrics, including the "cycle time" flow metric mentioned in class (currently empty, since no tasks have been completed yet).
3. Click on "More reports" at the top. You can activate a "Sprint burndown chart" immediately (i.e. to visualise your progress across stories within a particular sprint). After completing your first sprint, you can activate the "Velocity report" to visualise how many story points you delivered in each sprint.
4. Return to your space, then click on the newly available "Reports" link from the horizontal menu. Finally, click on "Sprint burndown chart":



5. Unless you have completed any stories, your burndown chart will look something like this:



6. At this point, try experimenting further: complete one of your user stories, and see how the burndown chart is automatically updated.

Note that frustratingly, Jira only offers burndown charts within sprints and **not** across sprints. The closest alternative is the “Velocity report” that you can enable after completing your first sprint.

If you use Jira for the IS212 group project, please manually create an across-sprint burndown chart (e.g. in Google Sheets) based on the stories planned and delivered across your sprints. 